

Adrien Wicht

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Citations [Google Scholar](#)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Macroeconomics, International Economics, Sovereign Debt, Public Finance, Recursive Contracts.

REFERENCES

Ramon Marimon Universitat Pompeu Fabra ramon.marimon@upf.edu	Alexander Monge-Naranjo Federal Reserve Bank of Atlanta alexander.monge-naranjo@atl.frb.org	Andreas Müller University of Basel andi.mueller@unibas.ch
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CURRENT AND PAST APPOINTMENTS

- **University of Basel** Basel, CH
Postdoc in International Economics
Principal Investigator: Andreas Müller.
03.24 – Current
- **European Stability Mechanism** Remote
External Advisor
Head of unit: Giovanni Callegari.
04.23 – 10.23
- **University of Pennsylvania** Philadelphia, US
Visiting Scholar
Sponsor: Dirk Krueger.
09.21 – 02.22
- **Robert Schuman Center for Advanced Studies, European University Institute** Florence, IT
Research Assistant
09.20 – 08.21
- **Swiss National Bank, International Policy Analysis Unit** Zurich, CH
Research Assistant
Head of unit: Alain Gabler.
07.17 – 07.18

EDUCATION

- **European University Institute** Florence, IT
PhD in Economics
Examining Board: Ramon Marimon, Alexander Monge-Naranjo, Mark Aguiar, Yan Bai.
08.19– 02.24
- **European University Institute** Florence, IT
MRes in Economics
08.18 – 07.19
- **University of Zurich** Zurich, CH
MA in Economics
09.15 – 07.17
- **University of Fribourg** Fribourg, CH
BA in Economics
09.11 – 06.14

JOB MARKET PAPER

- **Efficient Sovereign Debt Buybacks, 2026:** This paper challenges the conventional view that debt buybacks are detrimental to sovereign borrowers. Using a model of strategic lending, I show that buybacks can be rationalized as part of an optimal contract between a sovereign borrower and foreign lenders. In particular, buybacks allow bonds to function like Arrow securities. This is because they take place in the secondary market, where only legacy lenders operate, granting them market power, as opposed to the primary market, where new entrants ensure competitive returns. This mechanism can substitute for or complement standard implementations based on debt restructurings. The model is supported by recent empirical evidence from Brazil, where the buyback premium can be attributed to both limited secondary market competitiveness and reduced default risk. These findings offer insights into sovereign debt management and the implementation of optimal contracts.

PUBLISHED WORK

- **Commitment in the Canonical Sovereign Default Model (with Xavier Mateos-Planas, Sean McCrary and Jose-Victor Rios-Rull), 2025:** Journal of International Economics, Vol. 157, link.
- **Seniority and Sovereign Default: The Role of Official Multilateral Lenders, 2025:** Journal of International Economics, Vol. 155, link.
- **Making Sovereign Debt Safe with a Financial Stability Fund (with Yan Liu and Ramon Marimon), 2023:** Journal of International Economics, Vol. 145, link.
- **On a Lender of Last Resort with a Central Bank and a Stability Fund (with Giovanni Callegari, Ramon Marimon and Luca Zavalloni), 2023:** Review of Economic Dynamics, Vol. 50, pp. 106-130, link.
- **Demographics and the Current Account (with Joschka Gerigk and Miriam Rinawi), 2018:** Aussenwirtschaft, Vol. 69(1), pp. 45-76, link.

CURRENT WORK AND WORKING PAPERS

- **The Generalized Euler Equation and the Bankruptcy-Sovereign Default Problem (with Xavier Mateos-Planas, Sean McCrary and Jose-Victor Rios-Rull), 2026:** R&R Journal of Political Economy: Macro. Link.
- **Risk Sharing and Risk Reduction with Moral Hazard (with Ramon Marimon and Luca Zavalloni), 2026:** Submitted. Link.
- **Sovereign Debt Maturity and the Political Process (with Darius Adlung and Andreas Müller), 2026:** Link.
- **Fiscal and Environmental Policy under Limited Commitment, 2026:** Work in progress.
- **Sovereign Debt Buybacks in Advanced Economies, 2026:** Work in progress.
- **Sovereign Debt and Foreign Reserves Accumulation (Joint with Fred Seunghyun Maeng), 2026:** Work in progress.

POLICY PAPERS

- **Vision of Europe: European Debt in a Better Union (with Giovanni Callegari, Ramon Marimon, Rolf Strauch and Luca Zavalloni), 2026:** Work in progress.
- **Euro Area fiscal policies and capacity in post-pandemic times (with Ramon Marimon), 2021:** link.

TEACHING

- **Advanced International Macroeconomics** Basel, CH
Master course Fall Semester 2024, 2026
- **International Money and Finance** Basel, CH
Bachelor course Spring Semester 2025, 2026

TEACHING ASSISTANCE

- **Macro-Finance and Policy Design** Florence, IT
PhD elective course. Instructor: Ramon Marimon. 09.23 – 11.23; 09.22 – 11.22; 04.20 – 06.20
- **Macroeconomics III – Part 2: Incomplete Markets** Florence, IT
PhD core course. Instructor: Alexander Monge-Naranjo. 04.23 – 06.23
- **Macroeconomics II** Florence, IT
PhD core course. Instructor: Jesús Bueren. 01.20 – 03.20

CO-SUPERVISION

- **Darius Adlung**
University of Basel 2024-Current
- **Raymond He**
University of Texas at Austin 2025-Current

CONFERENCES, SEMINARS AND WORKSHOPS

- **2026:** Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics, BSE Summer Forum (ADEMU Workshop), EEA Meeting, 4th Public Debt Management Conference.
- **2025:** University of Hamburg, IMF Seminar Series, Econometric Society World Congress, EEA Meeting, University of Helsinki, European Stability Mechanism, Geneva Graduate Institute, University of Lausanne.
- **2024:** European University Institute, University of Basel, EEA Meeting, IMF Sovereign Debt Workshop, University of Konstanz, CEPR Paris Symposium.
- **2023:** European University Institute, Second PhD Workshop in Money and Finance at Sveriges Riksbank, 5th QMUL Economics and Finance Workshop, BSE Summer Forum (ADEMU Workshop), SED Annual Meeting, XXVI Workshop on Dynamic Macroeconomics in Vigo, EEA Meeting, Joint Banque de France and EUI Conference.
- **2022:** European University Institute, RIEF Conference, DebtCon5, BSE Summer Forum (ADEMU Workshop), SED Annual Meeting, 17th End-of-Year Conference of Swiss Economists Abroad.
- **2021:** European University Institute, University of Pennsylvania, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia.
- **2020:** European University Institute, ADEMU Workshop.

REFEREEING

- Journal of International Economics, Global Financial Studies, Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control, Australian Economic Papers, Harvard Peer Pre-Review Program.

AWARDS AND GRANTS

- Vilfredo Pareto Prize, European University Institute, 2024.
- Doc Mobility Grant, Swiss National Science Foundation, 09.21-02.22.
- EUI PhD Grant, Swiss Grant-awarding Authority, 2018-2022.
- The Ernst & Young Award, University of Fribourg, Best Bachelor of Arts in Economics, 2014.
- Prix de la Banque Cantonale de Fribourg, Collège Sainte-Croix, Best GPA in Law & Economics, 2011.
- Prix du Fonds Tesch, Collège Sainte-Croix, Best GPA in the French-speaking section, 2011.

SKILLS SUMMARY

- **Languages:** French (native), German (fluent), Swiss German (fluent), English (fluent), Italian (intermediate).
- **Software:** Anthropic Claude, Excel VBA, Fortran, Git, Github, Julia, Latex, Matlab, MySQL, OpenAI ChatGPT, OpenMP, Python, QGIS, R, Stata.